

Tiger trap
Tiger Woods (right) trails Stuart Appleby by 15 shots at the Bay Hill Invitational. Page D2



SPORTS

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Section
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Sunday,
March 21,
2004



CHRIS ASSENHEIMER

Tribe should close the door on old closer

Bob Wickman is a great guy, one of the most likeable and professional players in the business, but the Indians are better off without him. Wickman's dedication and tireless work to pitching again after Tommy John surgery is admirable, but the Indians are still better off without him. Why?

For starters, Wickman is a 35-year-old closer a little over a year removed from one of the most serious surgeries a major-league pitcher can undergo. Tommy John surgery is highly effective for younger pitchers, but the probability of returning to form goes down as the years go up.

It goes down even further when you're talking about an older guy like Wickman, who won't be a cover boy for Men's Health magazine any time soon. Looking more like a home run hitter for the local softball squad, Wickman stands 6-foot-1 and tips the scales at a media-guide listing of 240 pounds.

His drooping, king-sized gut is legendary around media circles, fueled by the two to three Bud Lights he hammers down after games — no crime, just probably not the best nectar for a guy trying to build his body up to beat Tommy John.

The odds of him making it through an entire season injury free while still being effective are long. If this recent setback (partial tear in the transplanted ligament) isn't proof of that, what is?

It sounds harsh, but the Indians are better off without him. The Tribe is a team built on young talent and one that is looking toward the future. The way it looks, David Ruske is that future as the closer.



Wickman



This One is done

Top-seeded Stanford gets bumped by 'Bama

The Associated Press

SEATTLE — Josh Childress watched from the end of the bench as Stanford's latest comeback attempt came up just short, bouncing off the rim.

This time, there was no fantastic finish for the Cardinal.

Dan Grunfeld missed a 3-pointer from the right wing at the horn and Stanford became the first No. 1 seed to exit the NCAA tournament on Saturday, upset by Alabama 70-67.

"We're extremely disappointed," coach Mike Montgomery said, looking stunned in the interview room.

"It's hard to figure what to say. We just never could seem to get on track." Kennedy Winston scored 21 points and eighth-seeded Alabama (19-13) shot 10-of-14 from the free throw line in the final minute.

"People think by our record that we're not a very good team," said Tide point guard Antoine Pettway, who scored 12 points. "But we just beat Stanford."

The Crimson Tide shot 34-of-44 from the foul line, riding the free throws to the round of 16 for the first time since 1991. Alabama heads to Phoenix next week to face Syracuse.

"We always felt we could beat anybody. Now we really know it," said Alabama's Chuck Davis, who scored 12. "They were the No. 1 team in the country, and it gives us a lot of confidence going to Phoenix."

Childress, the Pac-10 player of the year, scored 12 points but he fouled out with 3:16 to play and had to watch the final minutes. "I never felt like it slipped away," Childress said. "They hit their free throws, which was unfortunate for us, but I don't

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NCAA TOURNAMENT

Saturday's scores

(1) St. Joseph's 70
(8) Texas Tech 65

(10) Nevada 91
(2) Gonzaga 72

(5) Syracuse 72
(4) Maryland 70

(1) Duke 90
(8) Seton Hall 62

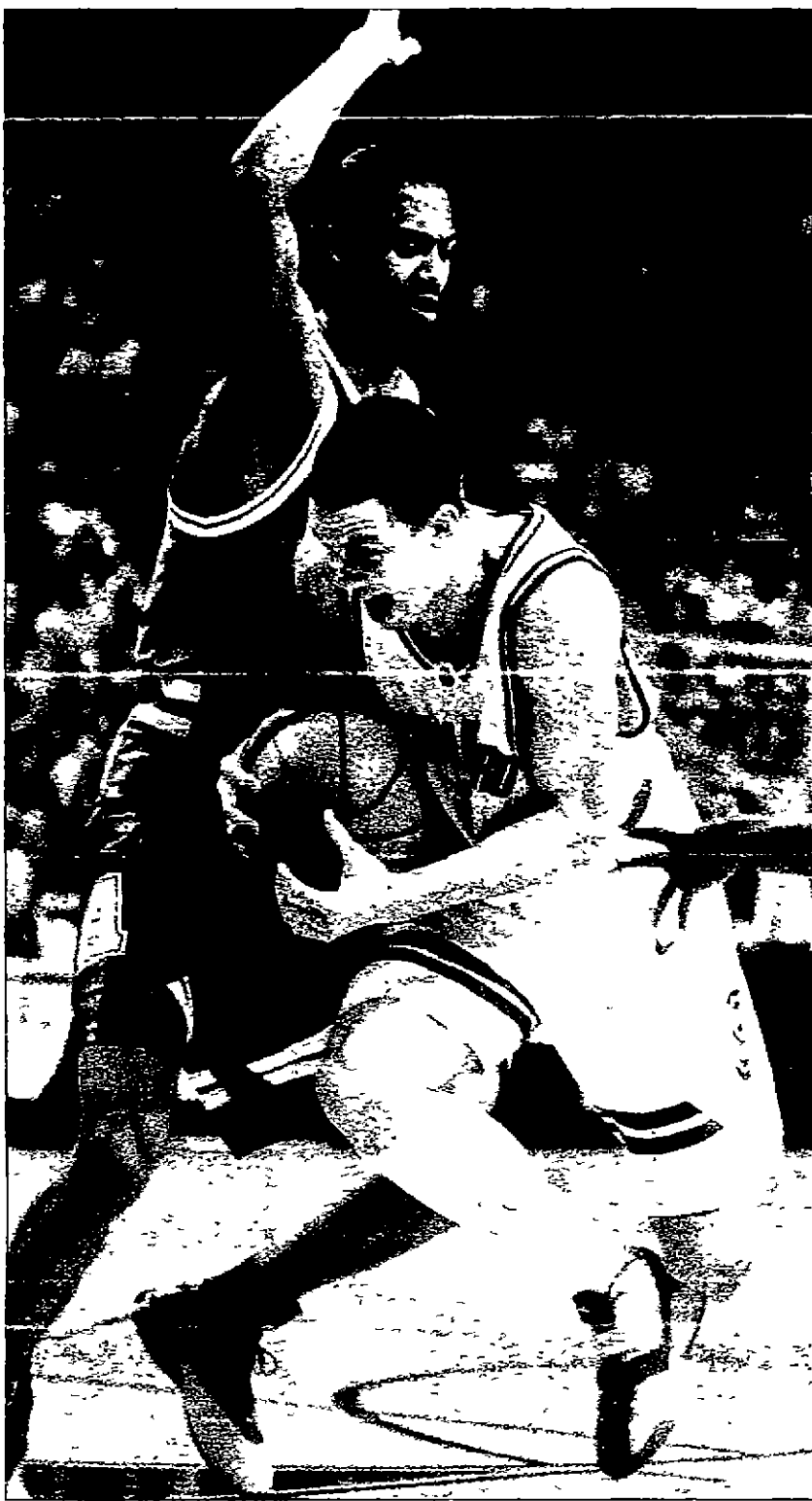
(4) Wake Forest 84
(12) Manhattan 80

(8) Alabama 70
(1) Stanford 67

(2) Connecticut 72
(7) DePaul 55

(3) Texas 78
(6) North Carolina 75

* Complete college basketball roundup on pages D4-5



Stanford's Nick Robinson drives against Alabama's Evan Brock during the Cardinal's 70-67 upset loss in Seattle on Saturday afternoon

New class headed to Elyria Hall

The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — A versatile golfer, two basketball greats, a baseball star-turned-coach and a track champion make up the 2004 Class of the Elyria Sports Hall of Fame.

Max Jalowiec, Ed Ransom, Bobby Warden, Steve Sunagel and Ron Rick will join the 1976-77 Elyria High School basketball team at the induction ceremony Thursday, May 20, at the Spitzer Center at Lorain County Community College.

Longtime C-T sportswriter and former Elyria Sports Hall of Fame board member Roger Negin will be honored with the Distinguished Service Award.

Jalowiec, originally nominated in 1993, was most known for his golf game but also excelled at bowling and softball. He designed Brentwood Golf Course and the back nine at Indian Hollow and had three holes-in-one. He was club champion at Spring Valley in 1942 and at Cherry Ridge in 1943.

Ransom was a key performer on Elyria High's 1965-66 team, the final for legendary coach Dale Reichenbach. Ransom led the Pioneers to a Buckeye Conference championship and a regional tournament appearance. He scored 378 points (15.8 average) and led the team with 235 rebounds, 103 on the offensive end. He continued his career at Lorain County Community College.

Warden helped Elyria Catholic to a regional appearance in 1982, when he led the county in scoring at 26.7 points per game and was runner-up in voting for Ohio's player of the year. Warden scored 1,286 points, a city record at the time, and went on to play at Sheridan (Wyoming) Junior College and the University of Hawaii at Hilo.

Sunagel was a three-sport star at Elyria High and went on to a big baseball career as a third baseman at the College of Wooster. He led the Pioneers in hitting as a junior, and in hits, runs, steals and RBIs as a senior. He won three letters at Wooster, and as a senior led the Scots in hitting (.378), runs,

See HALL, D8

COLLEGE WRESTLING

Percival 2nd

Amherst graduate loses final

From wire reports

ST. LOUIS — Former Amherst High School wrestling star Jake Percival was one point and 35 seconds away from an NCAA Division I national championship Saturday night.

But instead of getting the point and the title, Percival — now a junior at Ohio University — had to settle for second place when Stanford's Matt Gentry scored a 2-point reversal and then rode out the final 35 seconds for a 4-2 win in the 157-pound final at the NCAA Wrestling Championships.

"I thought we had him where we wanted him," Ohio coach Joel Greenlee told ohioobcats.com, a university Web site. "Jake wrestled the way we wanted to wrestle. It wasn't a bad match."

The loss was especially tough because Percival was close to scoring a point for a minute of



Percival

See PERCIVAL, D8

BOYS BASKETBALL

"I don't remember them missing. You're grasping at straws when a team shoots like that."

Pat Donahue, Olmsted Falls coach, after watching Toledo St. John's make 15-of-16 from the floor in the second half.

Smashed by the Titans

Olmsted Falls gets dumped in D-I regional final by St. John's

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

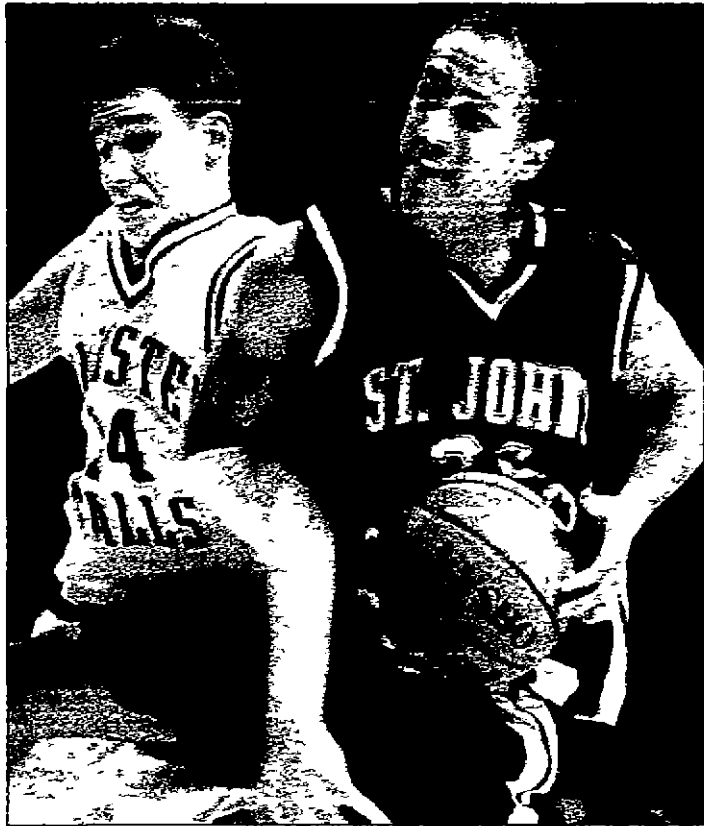
TOLEDO — Pat Donahue gave his starters, especially the seniors, a chance to take a final bow.

With 44 seconds remaining, Jamar Scales, Dan Binggeli and Steve Gansey went to the bench to the cheers of an appreciative Olmsted Falls crowd.

Gansey and Binggeli, in particular, have done so much for the Bulldogs program over the past four seasons, helping increase the school's conference championship streak to nine years and, this year, winning 22 games and the Division I district.

But the Bulldogs faced too big of a hurdle Saturday night in the regional championship game, losing to defending champion Toledo St. John's 79-62 before a

See FALLS, D10



ROSS WEITZNER / CHRONICLE

Olmsted Falls standout senior Dan Binggeli and the rest of the Bulldogs had trouble slowing St. John's Brian Roberts.

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